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Citizenship: Republic of Korea (F-1 Visa)

Fields of Concentration:
Primary Field: Industrial Organization
Secondary Fields: Applied Microeconomics, Econometrics

Qualifying Examinations Completed:
2023: Industrial Organization and Econometrics (*with distinction*)

Dissertation Title: *Essays on Market Competition and Policy Design*

Committee:
Professor Katja Seim (Chair)
Professor Steven T. Berry
Professor Philip A. Haile

Education:
Ph.D., Economics, Yale University, 2027 (expected)
M.Phil., Economics, Yale University, 2024
M.A., Economics, Seoul National University, 2021
B.A., Economics, Seoul National University, 2019 (*summa cum laude*)

Fellowships, Honors and Awards:
University Dissertation Fellowship, Yale University, 2026 – 2027
Arvid Anderson Prize Fellowship, Yale University, 2025 – 2026
Nathan Hale Fellowship, Yale University, 2024
Young Economist, 7th Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting on Economic Sciences, 2022
SBS Scholarship (Full Overseas PhD Funding), SBS Foundation, 2021 – 2027
Cowles Foundation Fellowship, Yale University, 2021 – 2027
Highest Honor Undergraduate Thesis, Seoul National University, 2019
Presidential Eminence Scholarship, Seoul National University, 2018

Teaching Experience:
Introduction to Probability and Statistics, Prof. Yusuke Narita, Yale University, Fall 2025
Math Camp: Computation (PhD), Department of Economics, Yale University, Summer 2025
Introductory Microeconomics, Prof. Cormac O'Dea, Yale University, Fall 2024

Econometrics II (PhD), Prof. Max Cytrynbaum, Yale University, Spring 2024
Econometrics I (PhD), Prof. Donald W. K. Andrews, Yale University, Fall 2023
Basic Computing, Prof. Hyunjoo Kim, Seoul National University, Spring 2021
Studies in Econometrics (PhD), Prof. Yoon-Jae Whang, Seoul National University, Fall 2020

Research Experience:

Research Assistant to Prof. Katja Seim, 2025
Research Assistant to Prof. Yoon-Jae Whang, 2019 – 2021
Research Assistant to Prof. Sukjin Han, 2018 – 2020

Publications:

"Testing for Time Stochastic Dominance" with Oliver Linton and Yoon-Jae Whang, 2023, Journal of Econometrics, 235(2), 352-371.
– Best Student Paper Prize, Korean Economic Association, 2020

"Minimum Wage, Social Insurance Mandates, and Work Hours" with Ji Hwan Kim and Jungmin Lee, 2023, *Journal of Public Economics*, 225, 104951.
– Top 50 Outstanding Research, Ministry of Education, Republic of Korea, 2024
– Korean Economy Research Award, Korean Economic Association, 2023

"Testing for Stochastic Dominance in Stata" with Yoon-Jae Whang, accepted, *Stata Journal*.

Working Papers:

"The Effects of Service Integration on Platform Competition and Welfare: Evidence from Fulfillment by Amazon," 2026 [Job Market Paper]

"Copyright and Competition: Estimating Supply and Demand with Unstructured Data" with Sukjin Han, 2025
– Extended Abstract at *26th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation*

Works in Progress:

"Automation with Market Power: Amazon's Robotic Warehouses and the Distribution of Welfare"

"Censorship and Steering in Platform Duopolies" with Michael C. Wang.

Seminar and Conference Presentations:

2027: NYC Media Seminar by Columbia Business School and CUNY (scheduled)
2026: UC Berkeley Haas Marketing; ESIF Economics and AI+ML Meeting; Yale FDS: AI for Social Science Workshop
2025: Econometric Society World Congress; ACM Conference on Economics and Computation; AI at Yale Symposium
2024: Asia-Pacific Industrial Organization Conference

Referee Service:

American Economic Review

Professional Services:

Organizer, Yale Industrial Organization Tea, 2024 – 2025
Organizer, Yale Economics Graduate Student Social Events, 2023 – 2024
Organizer, Yale Econometrics Reading Group, 2022

Military Service:

Sergeant, Maneuver Battalion, 37th Infantry Division, Republic of Korea Army, 2014 – 2016

Computer Skills:

Python, Stata, MATLAB, R

Software:

"PySDTest: Python Package for Stochastic Dominance Tests" with Yoon-Jae Whang, 2025
– Github: https://github.com/lee-kyungho/pysdtest

Languages:

Korean (native), English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (proficient)

References:

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Dissertation Abstract

The Effects of Service Integration on Platform Competition and Welfare: Evidence from Fulfillment by Amazon [Job Market Paper]

Digital platforms are extending their role beyond marketplace intermediation by integrating complementary services. Google and Apple, for instance, operate their own payment systems for app stores, and Google offers ad tech tools alongside its ad exchange. Amazon and Walmart also run logistics services that store and deliver sellers' products, and Fulfillment by Amazon (FBA) has been central to Amazon becoming the largest logistics operator in the U.S. Such integration by large digital platforms raises concerns about competition and welfare, prompting global regulatory scrutiny (*Epic v. Google*, 2020; *Epic v. Apple*, 2020; EC 2022; CMA 2023; *FTC v. Amazon*, 2023; *United States v. Google*, 2023). In this paper, I investigate the welfare effects of a platform's vertical integration of

complementary services, focusing on e-commerce competition between Amazon and Walmart in the U.S.

To what extent does a platform's integration benefit or harm consumers and sellers? While integration eliminates double marginalization arising from marketplace commissions and logistics fees, it also allows a platform to make its service exclusive to its own marketplace or more costly to use on a rival platform. Such foreclosure weakens cross-platform competition, with the magnitude of this effect depending on how much sellers' adoption of integrated logistics raises their costs of multihoming (i.e., selling on both platforms). Integration therefore creates a welfare trade-off, and its net effect is theoretically ambiguous.

I build an equilibrium model of competition between Amazon and Walmart to measure the welfare effects of integrated logistics. The model captures the welfare trade-off: platforms set commission rates and logistics fees jointly, accounting for consumer choice and sellers' multi-platform entry, logistics adoption, and pricing. I construct a unique dataset linking products and sellers across the two platforms, estimate the model, and document evidence of both pro- and anti-competitive effects of integration. The platforms hold logistics fees down substantially to increase commission profits, yet sellers who use FBA are much less likely to enter Walmart. The latter finding is further supported by a regression discontinuity design: Amazon classifies products into logistics fee tiers, and sellers facing discontinuously higher fees are more likely to drop FBA and sell on Walmart.

On net, counterfactual separation of FBA from Amazon would reduce consumer welfare by 19%. Although separation removes exclusivity and increases sellers' multihoming by 92%, it introduces double marginalization and raises logistics fees and commission rates, increasing consumer prices by 25%. Aggregate seller profits change little (+3%), yet separation substantially reduces the profits of small and medium-sized sellers and increases earnings inequality among sellers. A counterfactual policy that removes exclusivity and discriminatory fees while preserving integration, such as making integrated logistics interoperable, would target the anti-competitive effects of integration directly and raise consumer welfare.

Copyright and Competition: Estimating Supply and Demand with Unstructured Data, with Sukjin Han

We develop an empirical framework to study how copyright affects competition and welfare in creative industries, focusing on a design product—fonts. Copyright protects creative works against close imitation in a high-dimensional attribute space that is challenging to standardize and quantify. Using data from the world's largest font marketplace, we first construct a visual characteristics space using neural-network embeddings of font images. We then use descriptive tags and pixel-level analyses to confirm that the embeddings capture recognizable design features, such as boldness and script style. Event-study and regression analyses show that the entry of a new font reduces sales of visually similar incumbents by about 5%, while leaving dissimilar products unaffected, indicating localized competition in the characteristics space. We estimate an equilibrium model in which consumers have heterogeneous preferences over designs and firms make entry, positioning, and pricing decisions subject to copyright-based similarity constraints. Counterfactual analyses show that stricter protection would increase welfare by encouraging the entry of designs that consumers prefer,

yet the optimal level of protection depends on how technology, such as generative AI, changes cost structures.

Automation with Market Power: Amazon's Robotic Warehouses and the Distribution of Welfare

I evaluate the effects of automation on product and labor markets and study how market power shapes the distribution of welfare among consumers, workers, and the firm in the context of Amazon's adoption of robotic warehouses. In a competitive benchmark, adoption lowers variable costs and improves service quality, which benefits consumers. Amazon, however, can exert product market power to retain part of these gains. The retained share depends on the firm's optimal pass-through of cost declines and hence the shape of consumer demand. The effects on the labor market are ambiguous: adoption may expand scale yet displace labor, and labor market power further complicates the net effects. Using data on labor market outcomes, consumer expenditure and warehouse characteristics, I first exploit the staggered introduction of Amazon's robotic warehouses in an event-study design. I find that adoption decreases wages but increases employment in local labor markets. I then build an empirical model in which consumers allocate expenditures across retail stores, workers choose whether to work at an Amazon facility, and Amazon exerts both product and labor market power. I use the model to measure the aggregate and distributional impacts of robot adoption with and without each form of market power, and to conduct policy analyses including minimum wage increases and antitrust enforcement.